Import

JUNE 19, 2026



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Overview

Import is an excellent way to add records to the database. Currently, users can add Equipment, Scheduled Events, Warranties, and Work Orders with more Components coming. Most importantly, it is a means to add this data in a timely manner. Import allows users to add records for a variety of reasons including, but not limited to:

- Adding Facilities
- Receiving Equipment in bulk
- Converting a database

Users will find the tool is helpful in certain circumstances, but not others. There are pros and cons to using the tool versus using the other methods offered in AIMS 3. There are ways to ensure the process becomes quicker each time the tool is used. Regardless, organizations should develop codified workflows to state when and how the Import tool should be used. Since the tool is very powerful, it is advisable to set all Security settings properly to avoid adding inaccurate data to the database.

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New Versus Duplicate Versus Import

Within each Component is the ability to create a new record or duplicate an existing record. Like Import, both are useful ways to add data to the system. To help determine which is the most effective method to add data, users must consider the following:

- Accuracy – Will the method used provide the best environment to ensure the data will be accurate?
- Timeliness – Will the method used offer the most efficient way?
- Familiarization – How familiar is the user with the process?

New mode is the most familiar method to input data since it is a basic function of the system. It offers great accuracy since the user must input/review the data one field at a time. Using Required Fields, Administrators can ensure the basic information needed by the organization is entered. However, using New mode is not very time efficient. If users need to enter over twenty records, they may opt for Duplicate or Import.

Duplicate can help with the timeliness of adding records because the new record inherits its values from the original record. However, with larger imports, this process can still be time-consuming since the user is adding records one at a time. Users can anticipate its usefulness will diminish after about twenty records. Although this function is used less often than New mode, its operation is similar, and even users with little or no experience can quickly learn how to use it. This leads to a false sense of security where the user feels they are doing everything correctly. Users can fall victim to assuming the new record has **all** the same values as the first record and may inadvertently duplicate unique values, such as:

- IP Address
- MAC Address
- Employee Assigned
- Risk

Because of this, Duplicate could be the least accurate method.

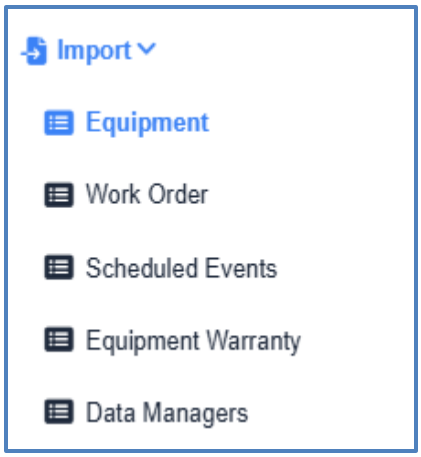
Import is useful because experienced users can develop workflows that add to the speed of the next import and the tool contains safeguards to prevent the entering of inaccurate data. While the initial setup of a successful import can take some trial and error, the artifacts created can be reused and refined the more the user uses the tool. For example, if an organization receives regular shipments of widgets users can keep and reuse a “Widget Workbook.” Since the user knows the workbook has been used in successful imports before, they only must change the information which is different (Tag Number, Cost Center, etc.). However, like Duplicate, this can lead to inadvertently duplicating unique values. Tools built into the Import tool, however, will validate the data to ensure it is able to be imported. Because of its functionality, Import remains the fastest method for importing bulk data. While importing one record would not be ideal, it is possible. Users

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must assess if it would be faster to create the Import workbook and use the tool versus using New or Duplicate. The answer is not always obvious.

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Import Menu



The Import Menu is located below Export and above Data Managers in the AIMS 3 menu. Currently, it includes:

- Equipment
- Work Order
- Scheduled Events
- Equipment Warranty
- Data Managers

Each Import Tool offers a corresponding Import Template to assist in preparing the information to import.

Note: Do not use an import template from one component in another!

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Equipment

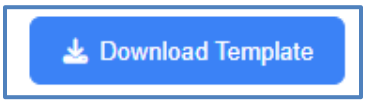
The Equipment Import tool allows users to add Equipment records to the database. As they are added, users can expect the records to inherit from the Model and Equipment Type Data Managers as they would if they were created using the new mode. This includes:

- Scheduled Events
- Risk
- Warranties
- Attachments

Any Automations for Equipment with the Trigger "Is Created" will fire as well. The fields which can be imported are the standard and Expansion fields in the Equipment record. However, if the Scheduled Events and Warranties are not inherited, then they will have to be added to individual records or imported using the respective tool.

The Equipment Import tool also contains the ability to update records. Currently, this cannot be used concurrently with an Import. The workbook used will have to be strictly import or updated.

Importing Equipment



The template needed to import equipment is in the upper right corner of the Import Equipment screen. Clicking the "Download Template Button" will download the XLSX file to the user's computer. Depending on the Operating System and browser, the file will be downloaded to the default downloads folder.

Tip: This file can be reused for future imports, or the user can decide to use a "clean" file each time. There are merits to both workflows. If an organization consistently received the same type of device, reusing the file will cut down on the amount of time to fill it in since common values are present. Using a clean file will reduce the probability of duplicating unique values mentioned in the Overview. Users should constantly reevaluate what is best for their organization.



After the template is complete with the information to be imported, the user must select the "Import" radio button. Then click the "Browse" button and use the popup window to locate the completed file. Then, the user selects the correct Worksheet for the data.

Tip: As mentioned above, workbooks can be reused. Users can also create multiple worksheets within a file to create a "history." Worksheets can be named anything, and it is

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good practice to name a worksheet a combination of Equipment Type, Date, and user's initials. For example, the worksheet could be named "Infusion Pump 08222022 MCB". This helps to resolve bad data and could provide a teachable moment for the user. It also assists Phoenix Data Systems' Tech Support, should they have to get involved.

After the file is selected, the worksheet will automatically default to the first sheet. If the user would like to use another worksheet, it should be changed at this moment. When the correct worksheet is selected, the Field Mapping area will activate. If the user is using a customized/non-conventional template, they must map the fields correctly, so the corresponding information is imported correctly.



Each line in the Field Mapping has four sections:

- **Required** – This will show if the field is required by either the system or Administrators (System Setup->Required Fields). If a row in the source file does not contain information in the respective required column, the import will produce an error.
- **AIMS Field** – This is the field in which the corresponding information will be saved. It is imperative users triple-check this and the File Field to ensure incorrect information will not be saved.
- **File Field** – This refers to the source column within the file. Cost Center should be aligned with Cost Center. However, users can reuse File Fields. For example, if the Cost Center and Responsible Center have the same data, users can eliminate one of the columns and use one for both AIMS Fields.
- **Auto-Create** – This is a very powerful option that allows the user to create Data Managers not already in the system.

Note: This option should not be used if the user is not attempting to create new Data Managers!

- **Multi-Value Options** – There are fields that can accept multiple entries. These include, but are not limited to:



    - Service Department
    - Employee Assigned

  When entering multiple values for a field, the user must define a delimiter using the "Multi-Value Delimiter Field" at the top of the Field Mapping.

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Tip: Users should avoid commonly used characters in fields, such as commas, apostrophes, and periods. This accepts multiple characters, so a unique combination should be selected.

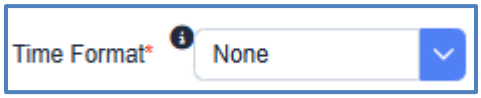
- **Date Format** – There are fields where dates will need to be set in order to fulfill the import. Users will need to select the Date Format which was used in the import to match what will be in AIMS 3. Entries include but are not limited to:



    - MM/DD/YYYY
    - DD/MM/YY
    - MM/DD/YY

Tip: Users can hover over the "i" icon to get more information on this field.

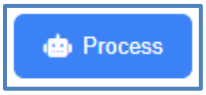
- Time Format – Time formatting must be consistent throughout the document, if not the import will fail due to lack of matched data. Time formats included are:

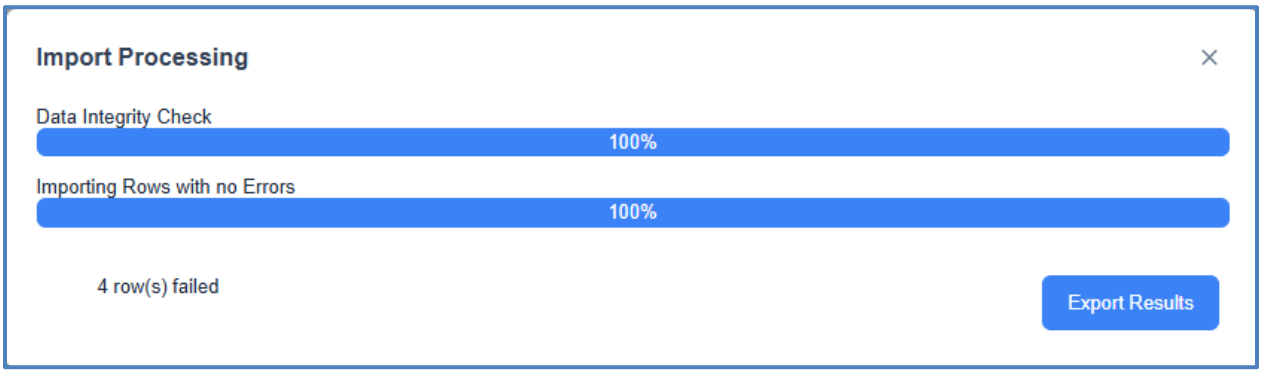


    - None
    - 24-Hour
    - 24 Hour with Seconds
    - 12-Hour
    - 12 Hour with Seconds

Tip: Users can hover over the "I" icon to get more information on this field.

Clicking "Process" at the bottom of the screen will begin the import process. The user will be presented with a popup screen showing the progress of the import.





First, AIMS 3 will conduct an integrity check. This will check the data against the Data Managers and the field types. After the file passes the integrity check, the data will be imported into AIMS 3.

If the data does not pass the integrity check, AIMS 3 will return the Import Template with an additional field explaining the errors. After the errors are remediated, the file can be retried.

Note: All imports should first be made within the test database as this will help with data accuracy.

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Work Orders

The Work Order Import tool allows users to add Work Order records to the database. As they are added, users can expect the records to be inherited from the Work Order Type Data Managers as they would if they were created using the new mode. This includes: Any Automations for Work Order with the Trigger "Is Created" will fire as well. The fields which can be imported are all the standard and Expansion fields in the Work Order record.

The Work Order Import tool also has the ability to update records. Currently, this cannot be used concurrently with an Import. The workbook used will have to be strictly import or updated.

The template needed to import equipment is in the upper right corner of the Import Work Order screen. Clicking the "Download Template Button" will download the XLSX file to the user's computer. Depending on the Operating System and browser, the file will be downloaded to the default downloads folder.

Tip: This file can be reused for future imports, or the user can decide to use a "clean" file each time. There are merits to both workflows. If an organization consistently received the same type of device, reusing the file will cut down on the amount of time to fill it in since common values are present. Using a clean file will reduce the probability of duplicating unique values mentioned in the Overview. Users should constantly reevaluate what is best for their organization.

Importing Work Orders



After the template is complete with the information to be imported, the user must select the "Import" radio button. Then click the "Browse" button and use the popup window to locate the completed file. Then, the user selects the correct Worksheet for the data.

It is essential to establish a Sequenced Work Order Number before proceeding! This ensure proper indexing and prevents errors during the Import Process! This process will change the sequence of work orders overall.

For example, if their current work order number is 9,999 and they begin an import starting at 100,000, and that import includes 1,000 work orders, their next new work order number will be 101,001 instead of 10,000. In other words, the system will leave a large gap in the numbering sequence.

The Worksheet will need to be selected whether you are adding labor, material, or Work Orders.

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The following drop downs of Include Labor and Include Materials will also be available to select in the case of added completed Work Orders to the Database.

After the file is selected, the worksheet will automatically default to the first sheet. If the user would like to use another worksheet, it should be changed at this moment. When the correct worksheet is selected, the Field Mapping area will activate. If the user is using a customized/non-conventional template, they must map the fields correctly, so the corresponding information is imported correctly.



Each line in the Field Mapping has four sections:

- **Required** – This will show if the field is required by either the system or Administrators (System Setup->Required Fields). If a row in the source file does not contain information in the respective required column, the import will produce an error.
- **AIMS Field** – This is the field in which the corresponding information will be saved. It is imperative users triple-check this and the File Field to ensure incorrect information will not be saved.
- **File Field** – This refers to the source column within the file. Cost Center should be aligned with Cost Center. However, users can reuse File Fields. For example, if the Cost Center and Responsible Center have the same data, users can eliminate one of the columns and use one for both AIMS Fields.
- **Auto-Create** – This is a very powerful option that allows the user to create Data Managers not already in the system.

  This option should not be used if the user is not attempting to create new Data Managers!

- **Multi-Value Options** – There are fields that can accept multiple entries. These include, but are not limited to:



  - Service Department
  - Employee Assigned

  When entering multiple values for a field, the user must define a delimiter using the "Multi-Value Delimiter Field" at the top of the Field Mapping.

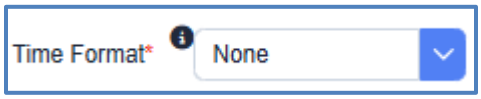
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Tip: Users should avoid commonly used characters in fields, such as commas, apostrophes, and periods. This accepts multiple characters, so a unique combination should be selected.



- **Date Format** – There are fields where dates will need to be set to fulfill the import. Users will need to select the Date Format which was used in the import to match what will be in AIMS 3. Entries include but are not limited to:
  - MM/DD/YYYY
  - DD/MM/YY
  - MM/DD/YY

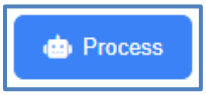
Tip: Users can hover over the "I" icon to get more information on this field.

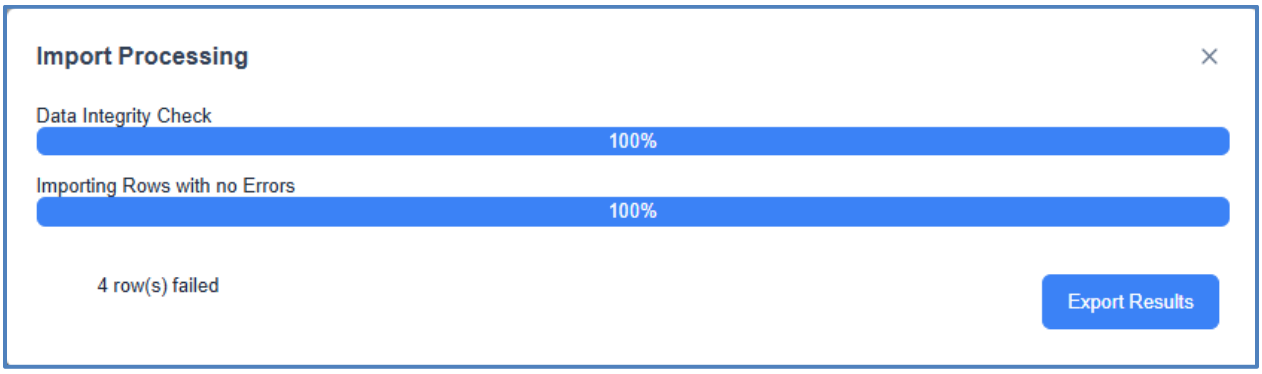


- Time Format – Time formatting must be consistent throughout the document, if not the import will fail due to lack of matched data. Time formats included but not limited to:
  - None
  - 24-hour
  - 12-hour with seconds

Tip: Users can hover over the "i" icon to get more information on this field.

Clicking "Process" at the bottom of the screen will begin the import process. The user will be presented with a popup screen showing the progress of the import.





First, AIMS 3 will conduct an integrity check. This will check the data against the Data Managers and the field types. After the file passes the integrity check, the data will be imported into AIMS 3.

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If the data does not pass the integrity check, AIMS 3 will return the Import Template with an added field explaining the errors. After the errors are remediated, the file can be retried.

Note: All imports should first be made within the test database as this will help with data accuracy.

Schedule Events/Warranty

The Schedule Events Import tool allows users to add Schedule Events to their database. They will be added to Tag Numbers that are already existing inside of the database, so if new tags need to be added, please refer to the section "Equipment" to see how to Import individual pieces of Equipment.

This same function also works the same with Warranty. Users can add warranty coverages of Labor and/or Parts to individual pieces of equipment. Since these two imports function similarly, they will be combined for the sake of this How-To Guide.

Note: While these imports function similarly, the Template will be formatted differently, so be sure to select the correct template before continuing.

The Schedule Event/Warranty option, unlike Equipment or Work Order, will not allow users to update. This will be used as a "new Only" feature when importing.

Importing Schedule Events/Warranties



The template needed to import Schedule Events & Warranties is in the upper right corner of the Import Work Order screen. Clicking the "Download Template Button" will download the XLSX file to the user's computer. Depending on the Operating System and browser, the file will be downloaded to the default downloads folder.

After the file is selected, the worksheet will automatically default to the first sheet. If the user would like to use another worksheet, it should be changed at this moment. When the correct worksheet is selected, the Field Mapping area will activate. If the user is using a customized/non-conventional template, they must map the fields correctly, so the corresponding information is imported correctly.



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Cost Center and Responsible Center have the same data, users can eliminate one of the columns and use one for both AIMS Fields.

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  This option should not be used if the user is not attempting to create new Data Managers!

- **Multi-Value Options** – There are fields that can accept multiple entries. These include, but are not limited to



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  - Employee Assigned

  When entering multiple values for a field, the user must define a delimiter using the "Multi-Value Delimiter Field" at the top of the Field Mapping.

Tip: Users should avoid commonly used characters in fields, such as commas, apostrophes, and periods. This accepts multiple characters, so a unique combination should be selected.

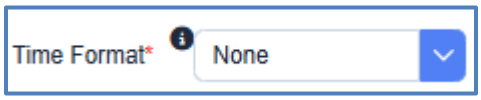
- **Date Format** – There are fields where dates will need to be set to fulfill the import. Users will need to select the Date Format which was used in the import to match what will be in AIMS 3. Entries include but are not limited to:



  - MM/DD/YYYY
  - DD/MM/YY
  - MM/DD/YY

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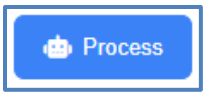


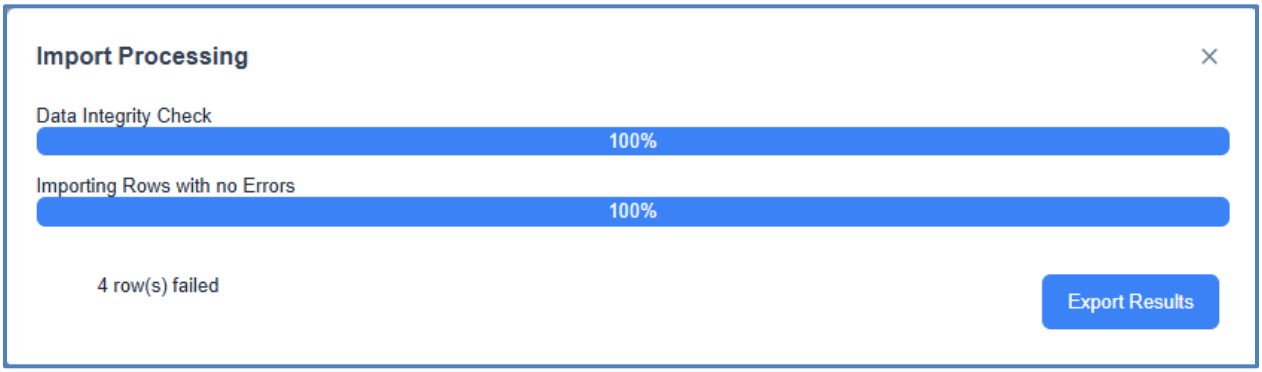
  - None
  - 24-hour
  - 12-hour with seconds

Tip: Users can hover over the "i" icon to get more information on this field.

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Clicking “Process” at the bottom of the screen will begin the import process. The user will be presented with a popup screen showing the progress of the import.





First, AIMS 3 will conduct an integrity check. This will check the data against the Data Managers and the field types. After the file passes the integrity check, the data will be imported into AIMS 3.

If the data does not pass the integrity check, AIMS 3 will return the Import Template with an additional field explaining the errors. After the errors are remediated, the file can be retried.

Note: All imports should first be made within the test database as this will help with data accuracy.

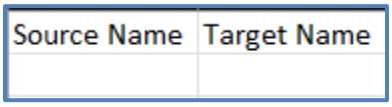
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Data Managers

The Data Manager Import works similarly yet differently from the other Components available to Import. Whereas with Equipment and Work Orders you can import new and update current Equipment, with Data Managers you are only able to Merge Data within the system.



By selecting from the dropdown, Users will need to select which Data Manger's data they will be merging before downloading the template. The Template for this merge/import will only have two columns:



- **Source Name** – Original name
- **Target Name** – Updated/merged name

Importing Data Managers

The template needed to import Data Managers is in the upper right corner of the Import Work Order screen. Clicking the "Download Template Button" will download the XLSX file to the user's computer. Depending on the Operating System and browser, the file will be downloaded to the default downloads folder.

After the file is selected, the worksheet will automatically default to the first sheet. If the user would like to use another worksheet, it should be changed at this moment. When the correct worksheet is selected, the Field Mapping area will activate. If the user is using a customized/non-conventional template, they must map the fields correctly, so the corresponding information is imported correctly.



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- **File Field** – This refers to the source column within the file. Cost Center should be aligned with Cost Center. However, users can reuse File Fields. For example, if the Cost Center and Responsible Center have the same data, users can eliminate one of the columns and use one for both AIMS Fields.
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  - Service Department
  - Employee Assigned

  When entering multiple values for a field, the user must define a delimiter using the "Multi-Value Delimiter Field" at the top of the Field Mapping.

Tip: Users should avoid commonly used characters in fields, such as commas, apostrophes, and periods. This accepts multiple characters, so a unique combination should be selected.

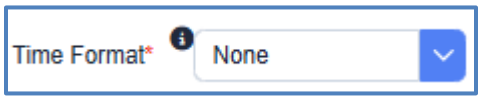
- **Date Format** – There are fields where dates will need to be set to fulfill the import. Users will need to select the Date Format which was used in the import to match what will be in AIMS 3. Entries include but are not limited to:



  - MM/DD/YYYY
  - DD/MM/YY
  - MM/DD/YY

Tip: Users can hover over the "I" icon to get more information on this field.

- Time Format – Time formatting must be consistent throughout the document, if not the import will fail due to lack of matched data. Time formats included are:

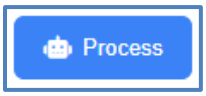


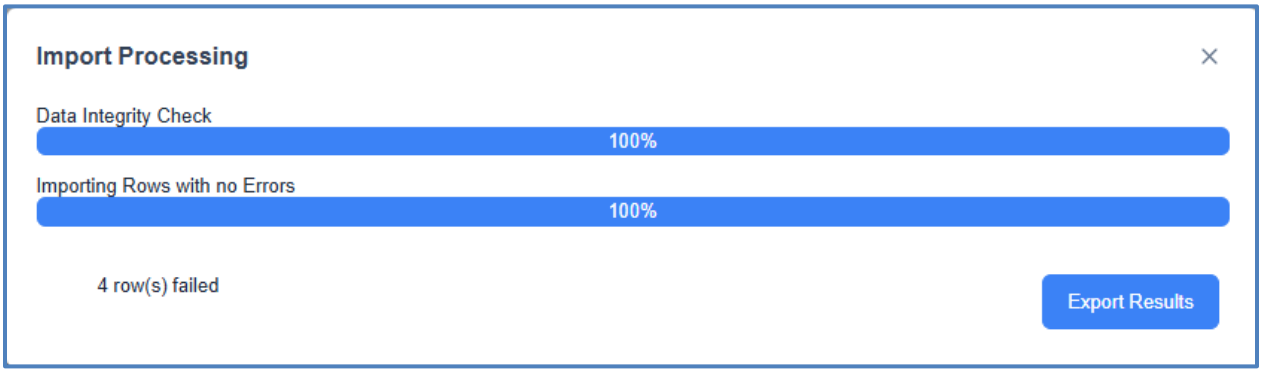
  - None
  - 24-hour
  - 12-hour with seconds

Tip: Users can hover over the "I" icon to get more information on this field.

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Clicking “Process” at the bottom of the screen will begin the import process. The user will be presented with a popup screen showing the progress of the import.





First, AIMS 3 will conduct an integrity check. This will check the data against the Data Managers and the field types. After the file passes the integrity check, the data will be imported into AIMS 3.

If the data does not pass the integrity check, AIMS 3 will return the Import Template with an added field explaining the errors. After the errors are remediated, the file can be retired.

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Conclusion

The Import Tool is used to help users and Administrators save time by adding dozens, hundreds, or even thousands of records in a single instance. This tool also includes the ability for updating records as well. This is an especially powerful part of AIMS3 in an Administrator's efforts to ensure consistent data.

If Administrators require additional consulting or training for the Import Tool, Phoenix Data Systems is available to assist at any level. Please contact our Sales Department or Project Managers for more information.

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Appendix

To support your learning, we've created a How-To Guide in video format that walks you through each step visually. Simply click the link to be taken directly to our YouTube page, where you can watch the full set of tutorials at your own pace. This is a great way to follow along, revisit key actions, and get comfortable with the workflow.

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